Project Proposal

College Lost & Found Management System

Software Engineering Course

Introduction

Students and staff lose personal items on campus every day, such as IDs, phones, wallets, books, and keys. Today, reporting and recovering these items depends on word of mouth, group chats, and informal handovers, with no central and reliable place to track them. This project proposes a web-based system that organizes the whole process in one platform, making it faster and more reliable for items to get back to their owners.

Problem Statement

- There is no central place to report lost or found items.
- Found items are handed to random people or offices, and the owners never hear about them.
- Social media posts get buried quickly and cannot be searched.
- There is no way to verify that the person claiming an item is the real owner.
- There is no record of what was found, returned, or left unclaimed.

Proposed Solution

A web system with the following main features:

- Users can report a lost or found item with a description, photo, location, and date.
- Anyone can search and filter items by category, date, and location.
- The system suggests possible matches between lost and found reports.
- Owners submit a claim with proof of ownership, and an admin verifies it before handover.
- Users receive notifications when a match or an update appears.
- Admins manage reports, claims, and unclaimed items through a dashboard.

Requirements

A. Functional Requirements

- As a user, I want to report a lost or found item with its description, photo, location, and date, so that others can identify the item and help return it to its owner.
- As a user, I want to search and filter lost and found items by category, date, and location, so that I can find relevant reports more easily.

- As a user, I want the system to suggest possible matches between my lost item and found items, so that I can identify my lost item more easily.
- As a user, I want to submit a claim for a found item with proof of ownership, so that I can prove that the item belongs to me.
- As a user, I want to receive notifications when a possible match is found or when there is an update to my report or claim, so that I can stay informed about its status.
- As an admin, I want to review and verify ownership claims, so that I can ensure that items are handed over to their rightful owners.
- As an admin, I want to manage lost and found reports, so that I can monitor and control the reports submitted to the system.
- As an admin, I want to manage ownership claims, so that I can review and process users' claims.
- As an admin, I want to manage unclaimed items, so that I can keep track of items that have not been returned to their owners.

B. Non-Functional Requirements

- The system shall return search and filter results within an acceptable response time under normal usage.
- The system shall maintain accurate and consistent data for reports, claims, and item records.
- The system shall be structured in a way that allows developers to easily modify and maintain the system.
- The system shall prevent loss or corruption of data during normal system operations.

Team Members and Roles

Team Member	Department	Role
Khaled Naseem Mahmoud Khafagy	Computer Science	Database Developer
Zakaria Hossam Zakaria	Computer Science	Backend Developer
Youssef Ahmed Ali Hassan	Computer Science	Backend Developer
Mariam Asaad El-Sayed	Computer Science	Frontend Developer
Salma Abdallah Ibrahim	Computer Science	Frontend Developer & UI/UX Designer
Basmala Ahmed Al-Damanhory	Computer Science	Frontend Developer & UI/UX Designer